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After dreadful start, Red Sox fire Cora

6 coaches also out; Worcester manager named interim



Alex Cora, who took over in 2018, was one of the team's longest-tenured managers.

By Peter Abraham
GLOBE STAFF

BALTIMORE — Red Sox manager Alex Cora and six of his coaches were fired on Saturday night, only hours after a 17-1 victory against the Baltimore Orioles.

In what was the first in-season managerial change under the Fenway Sports Group since it purchased the team in 2002, Cora was let go in his eighth season on the job. Triple-A manager Chad Tracy was named interim manager.

Bench coach Ramón

Vázquez, hitting coach Pete Fatse, third base coach Kyle Hudson, and assistant hitting coach Dillon Lawson were also fired, along with hitting strategist Joe Cronin.

Game-planning coach Jason Varitek was dropped off the major league staff and was reassigned to a new role, as yet determined, within the organization.

Pitching coach Andrew Bailey, first base coach José David Flores, catching instructor Parker Guinn, bullpen coach Chris Holt, and assistant hit-

ting coach John Soteropolus were the only major league coaches to survive the purge.

The 50-year-old Cora was 620-541 as manager, taking the job before the 2018 season and leading the Sox to the World Series championship that fall. His 620 victories are third in team history.

Cora was fired on Jan. 14, 2020, after it was revealed he had a leading role in the Astros cheating scandal when he was that team's bench coach in 2017. Major League Baseball
CORA, Page C12

Trump, others unhurt amid threat at dinner

Man with guns and knives taken into custody

By Seung Min Kim, Aamer Madhani, Collin Binkley, Alanna Durkin Richer, and David Bauder
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — A man armed with guns and knives stormed the lobby outside a high-profile journalists dinner attended by President Trump and multiple senior US leaders on Saturday night, rushing toward the ballroom before Secret Service agents swarmed him and took him into custody. The president was uninjured and was hustled away.

Guests went diving under ta-

bles as the scene unfolded and some reported hearing shots outside the vast subterranean ballroom in the Washington Hilton where the event was being held.

One law enforcement official said a gunman had opened fire. A law enforcement officer was shot in the bullet-resistant vest but is expected to be OK, several sources told the Associated Press.

The shooting suspect — described by Trump as a “sick person” — was identified as Cole Tomas Allen, 31, of Torrance, Calif., two law enforcement officials told the AP.

“When you’re impactful, they go after you. When you’re not impactful, they leave you alone,”

DINNER, Page A10

Is N.E. at turning point on nuclear?

Spiraling energy costs seem to point in one direction

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Forty years after the Chernobyl disaster, influential Massachusetts Democrats want to do what was once unthinkable: bring back nuclear power.

For decades, in the aftermath of the worst nuclear meltdown in history, Massachusetts has effectively banned the construction of new reactors. Now, Governor Maura Healey says it's time to build them again.

All six New England governors have signed on to study new nuclear technologies, setting the stage for a regional strategy. The rare bipartisan push reflects a hard reality. Poli-

cy makers are running out of time to address two major challenges: meeting climate goals and slashing energy costs that seem to be spiraling ever upward. Leaders say that nuclear, if done right, could address both.

“Nuclear needs to be part of the solution,” Healey said.

For many, that thought evokes deep fears about its catastrophic potential and the invisible yet devastating threat of radiation. In 1977, more than 1,000 protesters were arrested while opposing the construction of Seabrook Station in New Hampshire, the last nuclear power plant built in the region. Overcoming those long-held concerns won't be easy.

Yet to a growing group of climate and energy experts, expanding nuclear power is one of
NUCLEAR, Page A14

AFTER CHERNOBYL, THROUGH A PHOTOGRAPHER'S LENS

Three years after the catastrophic meltdown of the Chernobyl nuclear reactor, Globe photojournalist Suzanne Kreiter traveled behind the Iron Curtain. She looks back on her photos and their meaning. Below, a child was treated in Krakow, Poland, for an infection attributed to polluted air. **A12-13.**



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Amid the chaos of DOGE, the VA shed 48,000 staff last year, the largest one-year decline ever.



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Lidon Chevannes said the Northampton VA “is at a breaking point.”



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Eric Wasileski wonders what kind of care awaits today's troops.

Here in Massachusetts, 855 workers left, including 130 nurses and 71 psychologists. Vets are paying the price.

VETS LEFT BEHIND

By Chris Serres and Yoohyun Jung
GLOBE STAFF

NORTHAMPTON — Early last year, Dr. William Cutler felt a wave of anxiety sweep through the clinical corridors of the VA Medical Center in Northampton.

One by one, Cutler learned that long-trusted colleagues — psychologists, pharmacists, and primary care physicians — were considering leaving the sprawling medical complex in Western Massachusetts, overwhelmed by a steady stream of increasingly burdensome work directives from Washington.

Then, finally, it was his turn. After spending 17 years as an internal medicine doctor and chronic pain special-

ist at the VA, Cutler retired last April. His breaking point came with a blunt mandate from Elon Musk's Department of Government Efficiency, or DOGE: Either document five accomplishments he made each week, or risk losing his job.

“It was incredibly chaotic,” Cutler said of his final weeks at the VA. “People feared for their jobs and their patients.”

After Donald Trump returned to office last year, his administration vowed to expand health care for millions of veterans while cutting costs and trimming thousands of nonessential staff.

VETERANS, Page A11

We’ve turned a simple stroll into a whole thing

BETH TEITELL

COMMENTARY

My name is Beth and I'm not optimizing my walks.

I'm not staggering through my neighborhood in a weighted vest, a pack mule in Lululemon, supercharging my calorie burn and smug about bone density.

I'm not doing math while I walk, constantly checking my Whoop, my watch, and my

Oura to make sure I'm doing a certified Zone 2 walk, my heart beating at 60 or 70 percent of its max, whatever that may be, to improve mitochondrial function, whatever that may be.

I'm not Japanese walking, though Oprah has blessed it — not heading out at my regular pace for three minutes, then speeding up, then slowing down, then speeding up, and so on, so that if I'm walking with a friend who

WALKING, Page A16

Wellesley mother charged in deaths of her 2 children

Janette MacAusland, 49, is charged with killing her children, ages 6 and 7. She is being held in a Vermont jail and is slated to appear in Bennington County Superior Court in Vermont on Monday on a fugitive from justice charge. The deaths were discovered during a well-being check relayed by a Vermont police department around 9:30 p.m. on Friday evening. When Wellesley Police arrived at a home on Edgemoor Avenue, they found the two deceased children inside. The children, one in second grade and the other in kindergarten, attended Schofield Elementary School, according to David Lussier, superintendent of Wellesley Public Schools. Lussier added that a “crisis team” is preparing support services for families, students, and staff when schools reopen on Monday. **B1.**

Their sons and daughters vanished into the chaos of Mass. and Cass. They'll never stop trying to bring them home. **Globe Magazine.**

The latest cease-fire talks between the United States and Iran appeared to fail before they began. **A2.**

Budding system

Sunday: Some sun. High: 56.

Monday: Sunny. High: 58.

Complete report, **B12.**
Deaths, **A18-21.**

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